

The 6:15

WEDNESDAY · AUGUST 26, 2026

NO. 7

THE BOARD

CALENDAR — NEXT 10 DAYS

Wed 8/26 (today)	Q2 GDP 2nd estimate & corp. profits, July PCE price index, July durable goods, 8:30a (BEA) — none released as of press time. Nvidia aft. close — cons. rev. \$92.07B, EPS \$2.09; Salesforce, CrowdStrike (cons. rev. \$1.436–1.442B, EPS \$1.16–1.17) aft. close. Lisa Cook's deadline to respond to Trump's removal letter — unresolved as of press time
Thu 8/27	Marvell aft. close; jobless claims, 8:30a; Jackson Hole opens (thru 8/29) — theme "Financial Innovation: Implications for Payments and Policy"
Fri 8/28	Fed Chair Warsh's first Jackson Hole keynote, 10:00a ET
Fri 9/4	August jobs report (nonfarm payrolls), 8:30a (BLS)
Sat 9/5	Northwestern football opener vs. South Dakota State, 7:00p CT, Martin Stadium
Sun 9/6	Next OPEC+ ministerial meeting
Tue 9/16	Next FOMC decision

[DEVELOPING] Anthropic's public S-1 still unfilled as of press time despite reporting it could land "as soon as this week"; secondary-market marks imply \$1.05–1.15T vs. the \$965B May Series H. **(Valuation range single-sourced to secondary-market chatter, not company-confirmed.)**
[NEW] Firmus Grid raised a \$2B Series G from Nvidia, Coatue and Blackstone at a \$10.5B valuation — the largest disclosed VC round of August.

METRICS · TIMES ET UNLESS NOTED

Brent / WTI / spread	\$86.20 (–2.68%) / \$80.13 (–2.71%), live quotes Wed AM pre-open — a third straight down session. ~\$6.07 spread (Tue settle reported \$87–89.50 Brent / ~\$82.36 WTI across secondary sources; no clean primary print located)
UST 2y / 10y / 30y	4.24% / 4.70% / 5.23% (Fed H.15, most recent published, Mon 8/24 close). Tue intraday reads had the

	10y drifting toward ~4.64–4.66%, no official settle confirmed
DXY	98.99 (–0.03%, Wed AM)
S&P / Nasdaq futures	not confirmed as of press time — secondary reads conflicted
VIX	15.47 (–2.4%, Wed AM; opened 15.71)
Gold (spot)	~\$4,653, little changed, near 3-mo high
S&P / Dow / Nasdaq	7,677.28 (+0.3%) / 53,577.40 (+0.3%) / 26,151.30 (+0.7%) — Tue close
Nikkei / Hang Seng	66,433.04 +0.88% / 25,511.10 –1.92% (Wed Asia close)
STOXX 600 / DAX	651.90 –0.69% / +0.68% (Tue close) (DAX level not confirmed)
Retail gas, natl. avg.	\$4.0969/gal (AAA, 8/25)

HORMUZ COUNTERS

Closure	Day 178 (straits.live, 8/26). Iran's deputy FM said Tue the Oman understanding (see Lead) does not mean reopening — strait remains “militarily closed”
Transits	5 vessels Tue 8/25 (straits.live) vs. 3 crossings 8/23 (PortWatch, 85/day baseline) vs. Lloyd's List's 73 transits 8/10–16 (91 prior wk) and ~12/day Aug. MTD (vs. ~130/day pre-war norm) (vendor figures not comparable — different populations, different windows)
Strikes	None reported in last 24h. Crisiswide total remains 64 documented incidents thru 8/18 (Wikipedia tracker, not updated past that date) plus unclaimed Metro Venetian strike (8/24) — vessel resumed limited ops, proceeded to Fujairah
War-risk premium	VLCC \$10–14M/passage (Lloyd's List/Marsh, late July) — no fresher named-vendor figure located this run

Dark tankers **not confirmed as of press time**

straits.live's near-real-time single-day counts, PortWatch's baseline-comparison snapshots, and Lloyd's List's slower weekly/monthly commercial-transit aggregation measure different populations over different windows — don't net them against each other.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees

No new moves in last 24h. McMahon (thumb) & Fried (elbow) remain on IL; Stanton (calf) status unchanged since Monday

Knicks / Northwestern

Hart's reported 3-yr/\$60–62M extension remains unsigned, talks ongoing. Northwestern: no new moves

LEAD**HORMUZ**

Iran and Oman float an interim Hormuz corridor — and Tehran immediately says that isn't the same as reopening.

Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi and his Omani counterpart, Badr al-Busaidi, used a joint statement Tuesday to disclose an “interim framework” aimed at resuming shipping through the Strait of Hormuz — the most concrete diplomatic movement of the five-month crisis. The mechanism: a temporary joint maritime corridor roughly seven nautical miles wide, paired with a mine-clearance project to restore safe navigation. Under the proposal, inbound traffic entering the Gulf from the Gulf of Oman would run entirely through Iranian waters, while outbound traffic would cross both Iranian and Omani waters — a routing choice that keeps Tehran, not a neutral third party, in physical control of the corridor Muscat is brokering. The two sides agreed to continue technical talks over the next 30 to 60 days toward a permanent corridor, a framework for administering the strait, and a mechanism for information exchange, traffic management and maritime security services, and said they would also pursue parallel talks with other Gulf states bordering the waterway.

Oil's reaction was immediate and unambiguous: Brent fell for a third consecutive session, down 2.68% to \$86.20 and WTI down 2.71% to

\$80.13 as of Wednesday's pre-open, extending Monday's and Tuesday's declines as the crisis-premium unwind that began with Monday's Bessent sanctions rollout (see prior issue) continued on top of Tuesday's Iran-Oman news. *(Read: markets are pricing this as the first credible step toward de-escalating the physical blockade, not just another round of the rhetorical sparring that has characterized most of the past five months.)*

But the read and the fact diverge here, and the gap is the story. Iran's deputy foreign minister said Tuesday, in the same news cycle as the joint statement, that the Oman understanding does not mean the strait is reopening — it remains, in his words, “militarily closed.” That is a direct, same-day hedge from Tehran's own government against the interpretation oil markets are trading on. Nothing in the transit data supports a reopening yet either: single-day counts remain in the low single digits against an 85-vessel-per-day pre-crisis baseline (see Hormuz counters), and Lloyd's List's slower monthly aggregation still has August running near 12 transits a day versus a roughly 130-per-day pre-war norm. What actually changed Tuesday is narrower than the oil-price move suggests — Iran agreed to talk about a corridor under its own control, with a 30-to-60-day runway before any of the substantive questions (permanent administration, security services, who polices compliance) get resolved.

The second-order read is about sequencing, not substance. This diplomatic opening lands the same week as Monday's Treasury sanctions rollout (“Operation Economic Outcast,” detailed in the prior issue) and Bessent's explicit refusal to set an enforcement deadline for the countries most exposed to secondary sanctions. Read together, Washington's coercive track and Oman's diplomatic channel are now running in parallel rather than in sequence — and

Oman, notably, is the one Gulf state that has maintained a functioning line to Tehran throughout the crisis, which is precisely why it is the one able to produce a document Washington could not extract through sanctions alone. Whether that channel produces something durable in the next 30-60 days, or simply gives Iran a talking point to manage the sanctions pressure while the “militarily closed” status persists on the water, is the question the next several issues will need to track — not this week’s oil-price pop, which is already reversing gains built on a geopolitical premium that predates any actual change in enforcement.

POLITICS

Lisa Cook’s deadline to respond to Trump’s renewed removal effort lands today, per Deputy Chief of Staff Dan Scavino’s Aug. 5 letter requiring a response through the Director of Presidential Personnel by Aug. 26. Her attorneys, Abbe Lowell and Norm Eisen, have already signaled the substance of her response: the mortgage-fraud allegations are “as baseless now as they were a year ago,” and there is “no valid cause for removing Governor Cook” under Supreme Court precedent. (*Continuity, unchanged stance.*) No outcome — a removal action, a further extension, or no action at all — was confirmed as of press time. **(Flag.)** This letter was drafted specifically to satisfy the notice-and-opportunity-to-respond requirement the Supreme Court set in June when it blocked Trump’s first removal attempt; the Court has since agreed to hear the underlying removal-authority question on the merits, with argument set for January, so today’s deadline runs on a separate, faster track than that eventual ruling. Massachusetts holds its state primary Sept. 1 (mail-ballot request deadline was Aug. 25); South Carolina votes Sept. 9 and Delaware Sept. 15. The House-Senate government

funding gap — the Senate’s continuing resolution runs to Dec. 11, the House’s own version only to Dec. 4 — remains unresolved and unchanged since the last issue.

ECONOMICS

Today’s 8:30a data cluster is the week’s real macro test, landing before most of this issue’s readers are off the subway. The Q2 GDP second estimate revises an advance reading that already ran hot — 1.5% annualized growth alongside a 5.1% headline PCE inflation print and 3.4% core in the July 30 advance release. The July PCE price index, the Fed’s preferred inflation gauge, is a separate release the same morning; consensus per Continuum Economics has core durable goods orders at +0.5% versus June’s +0.6%. **(Flag: consensus figures single-sourced to one preview shop, not cross-verified against a second consensus provider this run.)** None of the three prints — GDP, PCE or durable goods — had been released as of this issue’s press time. Jackson Hole opens Thursday under the theme “Financial Innovation: Implications for Payments and Policy,” with roughly 120 central bankers, economists and officials from more than 70 countries expected. Fed Chair Warsh’s Friday 10:00a keynote is his first at Jackson Hole; he has publicly declined to preview it, calling it “a blank piece of paper,” and the address lands 19 days ahead of the Sept. 16 FOMC decision with the 30-year yield still elevated near multi-decade highs on fiscal-deficit concerns.

BUSINESS

Dick’s Sporting Goods posted its worst single-day stock move on record Tuesday, falling roughly 29% after missing both lines — EPS of \$3.53 versus a \$3.76 consensus, revenue of \$5.59B versus \$5.65B

— and cutting full-year GAAP EPS guidance to \$10.94–\$11.94 from \$13.27–\$14.27. The miss was concentrated in the newly acquired Foot Locker business, where comparable sales fell 3.6% amid heavy athletic-footwear discounting and bloated inventory; the core Dick’s banner still grew comps 4.9%, helped by 2026 FIFA World Cup-related demand. (*Read: this is the clearest evidence yet that the Foot Locker acquisition is a drag rather than an accretive bolt-on, at least near-term.*) Separately, the U.S.-Canada trade relationship deteriorated further: 50% tariffs on roughly \$20B of Canadian goods took effect Aug. 22 after three days of talks in Washington collapsed, and Prime Minister Carney has vowed dollar-for-dollar retaliation starting Sept. 8. (*Continuity.*) Anthropic’s public S-1 remains unfiled as of press time despite reporting suggesting it could land this week (see Board); Firmus Grid’s \$2B Series G at a \$10.5B valuation, backed by Nvidia, Coatue and Blackstone, was the largest disclosed VC round of the month.

TECHNOLOGY

Nvidia reports after tonight’s close in the highest-stakes single print of the week for the AI trade — consensus \$92.07B revenue (+96.9% Y/Y) and \$2.09 EPS, a deceleration from the triple-digit growth rates of the past two years even as absolute dollar growth keeps climbing. Nvidia has beaten Wall Street’s consensus in 22 of its last 24 quarters. Salesforce also reports tonight; CrowdStrike reports its fiscal Q2 aft. close with consensus revenue of \$1.436–1.442B and non-GAAP EPS of \$1.16–1.17, after an eighth consecutive EPS beat in Q1 and a raised full-year ARR guide of \$6.53–6.56B. (*Read: Monday’s pre-earnings chip selloff (see prior issue) suggests positioning has turned defensive into tonight’s print — less room for a “sell the news” reaction on a clean beat-and-raise, more room for*

a sharp downside move on an in-line quarter.) Marvell follows Thursday as the week's other closely watched semiconductor read on AI capex.

GEOPOLITICS

Russia and Ukraine traded another heavy overnight exchange. Russia launched Iskander-M ballistic missiles, Kh-31P anti-radar missiles and roughly 150 drones at targets across Sumy, Kharkiv, Zaporizhzhia, Dnipropetrovsk, Kherson, Kyiv, Odesa, Chernihiv, Mykolaiv and Poltava, plus occupied Donetsk. Ukraine struck two Russian oil refineries in response: the Afipsky refinery in Krasnodar, where falling drone debris killed two people and injured two more and sparked a fire, and the Novoshakhtinsky refinery in Rostov, which suspended processing after the attack. Both strikes extend the energy-infrastructure exchange that Putin, on Sunday, characterized as Ukraine opening “Pandora’s box” (see prior issue) — a framing that has not shifted since. Xi’s Sept. 24 Washington summit remains on the calendar with export controls the unresolved friction point; no new developments surfaced this run.

IRAN & HORMUZ

Beyond Tuesday’s Oman corridor talks (see Lead), the tanker Amara — seized by the IRGC near Qeshm Island on Aug. 17 over alleged non-compliance with Iran’s new transit-fee rules — has no confirmed status update past Aug. 21; whether it remains held is unconfirmed as of press time. **(Stale.)** The Metro Venetian, struck by an unidentified projectile off Ash Shishah, Oman on Aug. 24, has resumed limited operations and proceeded to Fujairah; no group has claimed responsibility. The Sept. 6 OPEC+ meeting (see Board) will be the next scheduled venue where Gulf producers publicly address the corridor talks’ implications for output policy, though nothing on the agenda has been confirmed as Hormuz-specific this run. The

threat classification across the strait remains at its tightest reading of the crisis, unchanged since the last issue, and — per Tehran’s own deputy foreign minister — still officially “militarily closed” despite Tuesday’s diplomatic movement.

SPORTS

Yankees	Lost 9-7 to Houston Tue 8/25 (Alvarez’s go-ahead triple in the 8th off Headrick decided it; García Jr. had four hits incl. a two-run HR). Host Houston again tonight, 7:05p. 74-57, 2nd AL East (GB vs. Tampa Bay not confirmed) .
Knicks	Off-season, no game. Hart extension talks ongoing (see Transactions) — still unsigned.
Northwestern	Off-season, no game. Opens Sat 9/5, 7:00p CT vs. South Dakota State at Martin Stadium.

Continuity. Dropped as unchanged since 8/25: Khamenei/IRGC command reshuffle, TSMC July revenue, Microsoft’s Maia chip order reporting, Araghchi’s standard rhetorical framing, the House-Senate funding gap, Northwestern’s stadium-venue details. For next issue: today’s 8:30a data cluster and Lisa Cook’s deadline outcome are the morning’s actual news — report results, not the preview; tonight’s Nvidia/Salesforce/CrowdStrike prints are the evening’s; Jackson Hole opens Thursday; watch for a clean Tue Brent/WTI settle and for the Iran-Oman corridor talks’ 30–60 day window.

Unverified figures are marked in red. Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.